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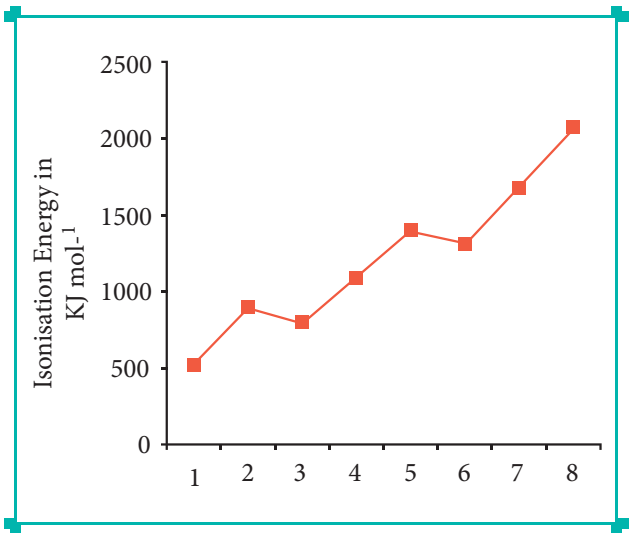
elements. The plot of atomic number vs ionisation energy is given below.

In the following graph, there are two deviation in the trends of ionisiation energy. It is expected that boron has higher ionisation energy than beryllium since it has higher nuclear charge. However, the actual ionisation energies of beryllium and boron are 899 and 800 kJ mol^{-1} respectively contrary to the expectation. It is due to the fact that beryllium with completely filled 2s orbital, is more stable than partially filled valence shell electronic configuration of boron. ($2s^2$ $2p^1$)

Figure 3.2 Variation of Ionisation energy along the I period



The electronic configuration of beryllium (Z=4) in its ground state is $1s^2$, $2s^2$ and that of boran (Z = 5) $1s^2$ $2s^2$ $2p^1$

Similarly, nitrogen with $1s^2$, $2s^2$, $2p^3$ electronic configuration has higher ionisation energy (1402 kJ mol^{-1}) than oxygen (1314 kJ mol^{-1}). Since the half filled electronic configuration is more stable, it requires higher energy to remove an electron from 2p orbital of nitrogen. Whereas the removal one 2p electron from oxygen leads to a stable half filled configuration. This makes comparatively easier to remove 2p electron from oxygen.

Periodic variation in group

The ionisation energy decreases down a group. As we move down a group, the valence electron occupies new shells, the distance between the nucleus and the valence electron increases. So, the nuclear forces of attraction on valence electron decreases and hence ionisation energy also decreases down a group.

Ionisation energy and shielding effect

As we move down a group, the number of inner shell electron increases which in turn increases the repulsive force exerted by them on the valence electrons, i.e. the increased shielding effect caused by the inner electrons decreases the attractive force acting on the valence electron by the nucleus. Therefore the ionisation energy decreases.

Let us understand this trend by considering the ionisation energy of alkali metals.

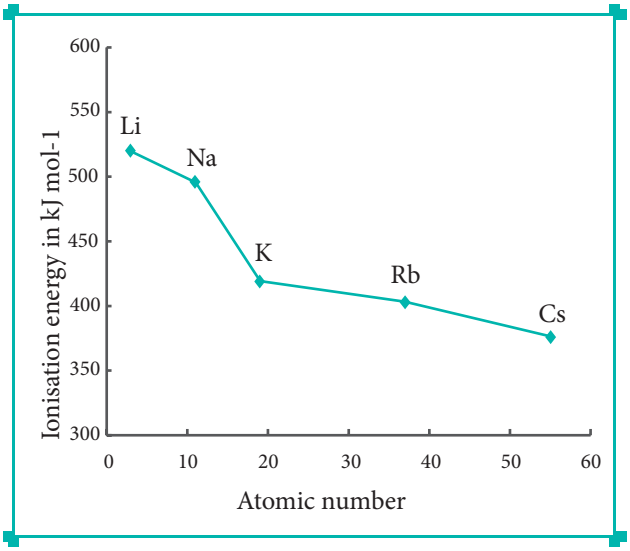



Figure 3.3 Variation of Ionisation energy down the I Group.